

1 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Fill the ten-frame

What we are practising

Represent a number and find how many more make ten.

What you need

Paper / Crayons

An adult draws while the child points.

Before you begin

Draw a rectangle split into two rows of five boxes.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Draw dots in the first six boxes, filling the top row first.
2. Count the filled boxes and then the empty ones.
3. Add enough dots to fill the frame and check the total.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How does a full row help you see six?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

The picture-price shop

What we are practising

Add quantities within ten and compare them with a limit.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use tally marks instead of numerals.

Before you begin

Draw an apple costing 2 points, a book 3 and a ball 4; prices are imaginary.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Choose the apple and book and draw two dots beside three.
2. Count their total and compare it with ten available points.
3. Add the ball and check the new total and remaining points.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How many points remain after buying all three?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Measure with a paper strip

What we are practising

Measure length with equal units and no gaps or overlaps.

What you need

Short paper strip prepared by an adult / Pencil / Book / Paper

Use identical large blocks end to end.

Before you begin

Choose a book roughly three or four strip-lengths long.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Align a strip end with the book's edge and mark its far end on paper alongside.
2. Move the strip to start at that mark and repeat without gaps.
3. Count full units and describe any leftover length.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What if we leave spaces between units?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Share six picnic sandwiches

What we are practising

Make equal groups and check each group's size.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use six large blocks and three drawn places.

Before you begin

Draw three guests and six sandwiches in a separate row.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Give each guest one sandwich by drawing a connecting line.
2. Repeat until all six are shared.
3. Count each guest's share and explain how you know it is equal.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Are shares of three, two and one equal?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Fold-and-check butterflies

What we are practising

Explore reflection symmetry around a central line.

What you need

Paper / Crayons

Match hand positions across a drawn line.

Before you begin

Fold paper in half, reopen it and draw a body on the crease.

An adult reads or explains as needed and prepares any cut paper pieces.

Try it together

1. Draw one broad wing on each side.
2. Add a large spot to one wing and a matching spot on the other.
3. Fold again and hold towards room light to compare approximate positions.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How far from the fold should each spot be?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Seven in two parts

What we are practising

Find a missing part of a small total.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

There are seven pretend apples. Four are on a plate and the rest in a bag. How many are in the bag?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Count the bicycle wheels

What we are practising

Count three equal groups of two.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Three bicycles each have two wheels and no extra wheels. How many wheels altogether?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

One sock without a partner

What we are practising

Recognise an odd quantity through pairing.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Five pretend socks are put into pairs. How many socks cannot join a complete pair?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The fourth boat in line

What we are practising

Find ordinal position when counting starts at a stated end.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

From the front, boats are red, blue, yellow, green and white. Which colour is fourth?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Nine steps or six steps?

What we are practising

Compare small numbers using their distance from zero.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A toy moves nine equal spaces on one path and six on another. Which trip covers more spaces, and by how many?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Two colours, one total

What we are practising

Add two unequal groups within ten.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A drawing has three orange flowers and four purple flowers. How many flowers altogether?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Tickets left in the strip

What we are practising

Subtract several items within ten.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend ticket strip has eight tickets. Three are given out. How many remain?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A sphere or a circle?

What we are practising

Distinguish a solid object from a flat shape.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A perfectly round ball can be held from all sides. Is its solid shape a sphere or a flat circle?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The rectangle's long edges

What we are practising

Recognise equal opposite sides of a rectangle.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A rectangle has one long side measuring six pretend units. How long is the opposite long side?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

A fair length comparison

What we are practising

Choose equal units for comparing measurements.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Noor measures with big paper strips; Ali uses little strips. Can their strip counts alone tell whose desk is longer?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Are both pieces halves?

What we are practising

Require equal parts when describing halves.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A paper sandwich drawing is split into a very big piece and a tiny piece. Are they two equal halves?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Read the favourite-colour marks

What we are practising

Read and compare counts in a simple data display.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A vote chart shows red: three marks and blue: two marks. Each mark is one vote. How many more votes did red receive?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Read the whole hour

What we are practising

Read a whole hour on an analogue clock.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A clock's long minute hand points to 12 and its short hour hand points to 3. What time is shown?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

The number before twelve

What we are practising

Locate a number immediately before another.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A number path reads 9, 10, __, 12. What number is missing?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Which number has one ten?

What we are practising

Connect a teen number to ten and extra ones.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult stays with the child, reads aloud and accepts pointing or gestures.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One bundle holds ten sticks, and three loose sticks sit beside it. How many sticks altogether?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Fill the ten-frame

A little hint

A full row is five; six is five and one more.

Answer / what to notice

Six filled spaces leave four empty; six and four make ten.

The frame shows the relationship between a number and ten.

Make it easier

Use one row of five with three dots.

Take it further

Choose another starting number and predict its missing part.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw ten windows and colour some as lit windows.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. The picture-price shop

A little hint

Cross out one of ten drawn points for each point spent.

Answer / what to notice

Apple and book cost 5; all three cost 9, leaving 1 from 10.

The total shows spending; comparing it with ten shows what remains.

Make it easier

Buy two items priced at 1 and 2.

Take it further

Choose repeated items to spend exactly ten points.

Another day, away from the screen

Invent another shop with prices up to five.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Measure with a paper strip

A little hint

Each new position starts where the last ended.

Answer / what to notice

The number depends on both lengths; describe a remainder as “and a little more”.

Keeping the unit size fixed makes measurements comparable.

Make it easier

Lay equal strips end to end instead of moving one.

Take it further

Measure again using a shorter unit and compare the count.

Another day, away from the screen

Estimate another book before measuring it.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Share six picnic sandwiches

A little hint

Compare the guests' numbers, not just the total.

Answer / what to notice

Each guest gets two; three, two and one would be unequal.

Sharing one at a time helps keep the groups equal.

Make it easier

Share four items between two guests.

Take it further

Share seven whole items between three and identify the remainder.

Another day, away from the screen

Share drawing tools equally for a joint picture.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Fold-and-check butterflies

A little hint

Match height and distance from the middle.

Answer / what to notice

Matching features lie on opposite sides at equal distances from the fold; approximate drawings are fine.

Reflection reverses sides while preserving distance from the central line.

Make it easier

Match just one spot per wing.

Take it further

Add a second pair of differently shaped markings.

Another day, away from the screen

Find an approximately symmetrical household object.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. Seven in two parts

A little hint

Count on from four until you reach seven.

Answer / what to notice

Three apples.

Four and three make seven; $7 - 4 = 3$.

Make it easier

Draw seven circles and surround four.

Take it further

If two are on the plate instead, how many are in the bag?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Count the bicycle wheels

A little hint

Count two, four, then the next pair.

Answer / what to notice

Six wheels.

Three groups of two give $2 + 2 + 2 = 6$.

Make it easier

Draw each bicycle as two circles.

Take it further

How many wheels would four such bicycles have?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. One sock without a partner

A little hint

Make groups of two until you cannot.

Answer / what to notice

One sock.

Two pairs use four socks, leaving one. Five is an odd number.

Make it easier

Show five fingers and identify two pairs.

Take it further

Would six socks leave one over?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. The fourth boat in line

A little hint

Call red first and count forward.

Answer / what to notice

Green.

Green follows the first three boats, so it is fourth.

Make it easier

An adult draws five coloured marks.

Take it further

Which boat is fourth when counting from the other end?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. Nine steps or six steps?

A little hint

Match six spaces on both paths, then count extras.

Answer / what to notice

The nine-space trip, by three spaces.

Nine is greater than six, and $9 - 6 = 3$.

Make it easier

Answer only which has more first.

Take it further

How many spaces should be added to six to reach nine?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. Two colours, one total

A little hint

Start at four and count three more.

Answer / what to notice

Seven flowers.

The colour does not change the total: $3 + 4 = 7$.

Make it easier

Show the groups on two hands.

Take it further

If one flower fades but stays in the picture, does the total change?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Tickets left in the strip

A little hint

Start with eight and count back three steps.

Answer / what to notice

Five tickets.

Removing three from eight leaves five: $8 - 3 = 5$.

Make it easier

Draw eight marks and cross out three.

Take it further

How many have been given out if only two remain?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. A sphere or a circle?

A little hint

Think about a drawing on paper compared with an object.

Answer / what to notice

A sphere.

A sphere is a three-dimensional solid; a circle is a flat two-dimensional shape.

Make it easier

Compare an imagined ball with a drawn ring.

Take it further

Name another object with an approximately spherical shape.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. The rectangle's long edges

A little hint

Opposite sides of a rectangle match.

Answer / what to notice

Six units.

A rectangle has equal opposite sides, even if its shorter sides differ in length.

Make it easier

Draw a rectangle and point to the opposite sides.

Take it further

If a short side is two units, how long is its opposite side?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. A fair length comparison

A little hint

Each counted strip should represent the same length.

Answer / what to notice

No. Use equal-length strips first.

Different unit sizes can give different counts for the same length.

Make it easier

Imagine one long strip replacing two short strips.

Take it further

Explain why the strips should touch without gaps or overlaps.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Are both pieces halves?

A little hint

Half means one of two equal parts.

Answer / what to notice

No; they are two parts, but not equal halves.

Making two pieces is not enough: both need equal size to be halves of the same whole.

Make it easier

Imagine folding a rectangle so its edges meet.

Take it further

Can two differently shaped pieces still have equal area?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. Read the favourite-colour marks

A little hint

Match two marks on each side.

Answer / what to notice

One more vote.

Red has three votes and blue two, so $3 - 2 = 1$.

Make it easier

Ask which colour has more before finding the difference.

Take it further

How many children voted if each voted once?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. Read the whole hour

A little hint

At a whole hour, the minute hand points to 12.

Answer / what to notice

Three o'clock.

The short hand gives the hour; the long hand at 12 means zero minutes past it.

Make it easier

Focus on the short hand first.

Take it further

Where will the hour hand point one hour later?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. The number before twelve

A little hint

Count forward one step after ten.

Answer / what to notice

Eleven.

Eleven comes after ten and immediately before twelve.

Make it easier

Say nine, ten, eleven, twelve together.

Take it further

What is two steps before twelve?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Which number has one ten?

A little hint

Keep ten together and count three more.

Answer / what to notice

Thirteen sticks.

Ten and three ones make thirteen: $10 + 3 = 13$.

Make it easier

An adult draws a group labelled ten and three marks.

Take it further

What if there were five loose sticks beside the ten?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.